

standardized the French language, eliminating the variations that existed in different regions of his kingdom.

What mattered most to Leonardo was the fact that the king was a gracious host. The French Court was based at Amboise in the Loire Valley. The king lived in the Château d'Amboise, a grand palace that had become a favorite home of recent French kings. It had been renovated and expanded, and now had many more rooms than Francis needed.

DID YOU KNOW?

In 1530, Francis declared French, rather than Latin, to be the official language of France.

Château d'Amboise,
home of Francis I.

